

Alexander Bereck

561-254-4169 alexander@zinaeva.com New York, New York

Profile

Game designer focused on narrative systems, player agency, cultural storytelling, and how games create meaning through their worlds. Currently developing Birdsong, a mystery adventure game exploring identity and nostalgia in the digital era. Background in user behavior research and cultural analysis applied to interactive experiences.

Recent Experience

Video Game Designer and Developer, (In Development) – Spring 2025-present

- ▶ **Developing a narrative-driven mystery adventure in Unity** set in the early 2010s exploring themes of digital romanticism, nostalgia, and identity formation.
- ▶ **Designing social mechanics, investigation systems, and branching narrative paths** that respond to player choices and environmental exploration.
- ▶ **Conducting cultural and historical research** into early 2010s aesthetics, collegiate life, and digital communication patterns to build an authentic period setting.
- ▶ **Writing character dialogue, environmental storytelling, and thematic content** examining parasocial relationships and the intersection of online/offline identity.

Product and Video Game Designer, BePresent – Fall 2025

- ▶ **Designed three comprehensive gamification systems** for the screen time wellness app, healing anxiety and screen addiction using AI and user-generated activity prompts related to rejection therapy, self reflection, and collaborative goals.
- ▶ **Created frameworks** bridging individual progress and collective motivation.

User Behavior Researcher and Community Growth Strategist, 222 place – Spring-Fall 2025

- ▶ **Conducted ethnographic research analyzing engagement patterns** and how design intent diverges from community participation in digital third space experiences to inform growth initiatives.
- ▶ **Launched the AI-powered in-person social media platform in four global cities**, managing 50+ influencer partnerships, driving user acquisition around social connection for new markets.

3D Design Researcher and Educator, SoundSense/Mila Perez – Fall 2024-Summer 2025

- ▶ **Contributed 3D design work and accessibility research** for audio-accessible speaker development.
- ▶ Taught Blender 3D modeling workflows to team members.

Education

B.A. in English, and Mandarin, Fordham University, New York, New York – Spring 2025

- ▶ **Coursework:** Video Game Culture, Theory & Practice · Digital Storytelling · Digital Ethnography

Skills

- ▶ **Technical:** Unity · Unreal Engine · Twine · RPG Maker · Blender · Photoshop · Photogrammetry · Web development · UI/UX design · Version control and prototyping · Technical documentation · Character design · Level design · Progression systems · World building · Interactive environmental storytelling
- ▶ **Professional/Soft:** Cross-functional collaboration · Creative problem solving · Mandarin language (conversational) · Scope consciousness · User analysis